

Earthbux

A public forum that directs pooled philanthropic missions —
and an independent newsroom that follows the money.

You donate, we follow.

Elect a philanthropic cause, a specific mission, and the organization that runs it.

First seven causes: atmosphere · oceans · land · forests · wildlife · human rights · human progress

Charitable money is warehoused, and donors never find out where it went.

0%

Legally required annual payout for a commercial donor-advised fund. Fidelity Charitable took in ~\$16B in 2024.

35%

Share of DAF accounts that paid out *nothing* in a studied year.

5%

The minimum a private foundation must release. Lilly (\$79.9B) and Gates (\$78.7B) hold ~44% of the top-50's assets.

The deduction is taken the day the money leaves; the *gift* can wait forever. Meanwhile it sits invested — the donor's share and the public's, because a deduction is tax that was never paid. Most people give modestly, at tax time, and never learn that **most of what they gave is sitting in corporate equity**.

And the totals flatter it: a deposit counts as giving the day it is deducted, not the day it arrives — while a foundation can meet its 5% by granting into a DAF, which owes nothing. The money moves, and still hasn't gone anywhere.

The money that *does* move is barely policed.

50¢ In half of 588 audited New York campaigns (2024), the charity kept under fifty cents on the dollar. 104 lost money outright.

\$16.25 Value booked for a deworming pill that costs about 2¢. Overvalued goods turn a 65% program ratio into 95%.

734% One charity's program spending overstated — \$7.75M reported against \$929k — using an accounting rule that permits it.

10 pts How far reported overhead is understated sector-wide (peer-reviewed, 2024) — the one number donors are told to check.

None of this is hidden. It is disclosed, audited and legal — the rules permit the valuation, the allocation and the solicitation. **What is missing is any consequence for using them.**

People are generous — and hesitant to give without options, control, and a reason to look.

No options, and nobody to tell you

Finding something worth funding is unpaid research. No beat, no critic, no column — so the winner is whoever asked loudest. Advertising is the only media most causes get.

No control, and no follow-up

You cannot vote on the target, and nothing reports back. The only account of your donation is written by the people who took it.

Nobody is watching — and not by accident

A \$600B sector with no beat. Maybe the silence isn't because charity is boring — maybe the people it would embarrass prefer you think so.

Attention is the standard now

Everything that wants participation has a network and content behind it. Charity still asks the way institutions asked in 1985.

An election gives **options and control**. A newsroom gives **feedback and a reason to look**. So we built both into the donation itself — and what makes it worth watching is what keeps it honest.

Every mission is elected twice.

1 · Mission Election

Benefactors commit to an *initiative* inside the week's cause. The winner becomes the mission. Nothing is chosen yet but the idea.



2 · Organization Election

Benefactors elect the organization that will run it — on its record and its statement, before any plan exists.



3 · The mission runs

Money releases in stages against a published budget, and Earthbux News reports each one.

The Forum runs underneath all of it, not between the votes. It elects the causes before any of this begins, argues the initiatives while the race is open, and carries on afterwards as research, itemized budgets and progress review.

Then the three of us are bound to one mission: **Earthbux reports, the organization executes, the benefactors deliberate** — and **every step is approved before it happens.** We capture the donor and the media consumer in the same motion.

Where every dollar sits — and who still controls it.

~30% awarded to the elected organization

≤30% ceiling on what Earthbux can ever consume

~40% stays as benefactor-held EBX, released as the mission proves itself

One coin per mission

Donate and your money becomes **mission-specific EBX**. Many sources converge on one mission, and you track all of it by looking at that mission's coin — its value moves with what the mission actually resolves.

Only about a tenth crosses at the election. **Most of the money stays under the benefactors' control well into the mission**, and is released against published budgets and reports.

Power to the small donor

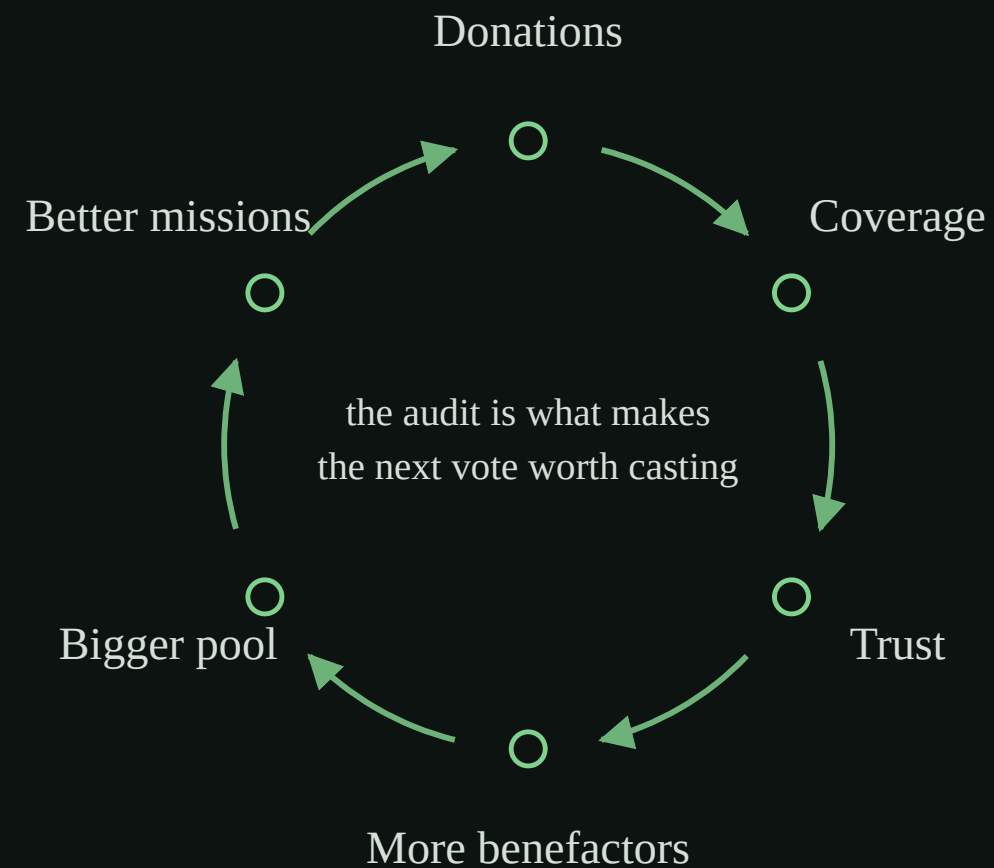
Everyone is granted **\$1 a week** to allocate — free, and spendable only in that week's elections. Buying more never buys proportional power: each additional block of ten counts for half the block before it (10 → 10.00, 20 → 15.00, 40 → 18.75).

Being early is what pays

Right about the initiative → the lowest cost basis · voted at all → a middling basis · donating later → a higher one. Conviction is priced before consensus is.

WHY IT HOLDS

The newsroom is the moat.



Anyone can build a voting UI. Almost nobody can build the standing to *audit where the money went*, and that audit is why the next vote matters.

Every donation passes through layers

Two votes · a signed claim attestation · identity verification by the newsroom · a community-approved budget · release step by step against published reports, ours beside theirs.

Leaving is feedback, not leakage

Benefactors keep control of most of their money well into the mission — and holding it, moving it or taking it back is a public signal no grantmaker has ever had. None of what they build here — history, coins, memberships — ports anywhere else.

Everyone else moves the money. Nobody covers it.

TIER	WHO	PAYS OUT	DONOR DECIDES?	INDEPENDENT REPORTING?
Endowed grantmakers	Private foundations	5% / yr, minimum	No	No
Pooled pass-throughs	Commercial DAFs, giving circles	No requirement	Advisory	No
Direct operating	GiveDirectly, GlobalGiving	Continuously	Pick a project	Self-reported
Earthbux	A giving circle crossed with a newsroom	Weekly	Votes on both	In-house, adversarial

The closest analogues are good organizations. None lets the donor *vote* on the target and then pays someone independent to *go and check*.

Allies: community foundations, Philanthropy Together, GiveDirectly, GlobalGiving. Investigative subjects: DAF sponsors, low-payout endowments.

Our benchmark isn't a foundation — *it's a feed*. People show up to be seen contributing: the post that changed a budget, the research that won the week. The causes matter, and so do the people who show up for them.

THE PRODUCT

Built, and built to be used every week.

Landing

What Earthbux is, and this week's decision.

Elections

The floor: seven causes, two live races, your allocation.

News

The feed. Scrolling, reactions, articles, argument.

Missions

One mission's status, budget, steps and coin.

Profile

Your wallet, your memberships, your record.

Engagement is the product, not a growth tactic. Rewards, reactions, content people make and content people consume — all of it free, all of it seamless. **They don't show up to donate. They show up to be included**, and the donation is what being included looks like.

To shoot: one screenshot per surface, one line of substance under each — what a benefactor *does* there, not what the page contains. A 20-second recording beats all five if the room allows video.

The machine is built. It is being run by one person.

Standing today

- Five surfaces live: landing, elections, news, missions, profile.
- The full election machine — two elections, seven staggered causes, a self-advancing weekly clock.
- The wallet and money model, asserted by eleven check scripts.
- The structured forum: three post categories, rated, rewarded, versioned.

Not yet

- No mission has run end to end. No check has been written.
- Organization registration, verification and outbound contact are unbuilt.
- Charitable status unfiled — money cannot legally flow until it exists.

There is no traction slide, on purpose: numbers before a mission has run would be theatre. **What exists is the mechanism** — and the reason it isn't further along is that there is one of me.

In the order that it blocks me.

- 01 People.** Six roles keep this honest and none of them are filled. Every one of them is a job I am currently doing badly.
- 02 Charitable status.** 501(c)(3) or a fiscal sponsor. Donations cannot reach an organization until it exists, and the clock on it is measured in months, not sprints.
- 03 Banking and custody.** Where pooled money lives between the donation and the check.
- 04 The first cohort of organizations.** Verified, claimed, and on the record — the counterparties that make the first mission real.
- 05 Time to run one mission end to end** and publish the audit at the end of it.

Four of those five are not engineering. **They are the critical path** — and they are what a check buys that another year of building would not.

Six roles keep it honest.

Journalist. Turns the scientist's, the relations manager's and the auditor's reporting into the mission's story — the output everyone else exists to make true.

Mission auditor. Tracks whether the money sent is the money spent, and records it.

Organization relations manager. Verifies that an organization is who it says, then keeps the relationship worth having.

Scientist. Studies the causes and initiatives rigorously, so the ballot isn't a contest between slogans.

Site auditor. Keeps research, posts, initiatives and accounts real and within the rules.

UI/UX designer. Keeps a complicated machine friendly enough to come back to on a Tuesday.

This is where the newsroom's share of every pool goes — the line item an investor is really funding. One reward we intend to pay: we send someone to travel with the mission.

COST ANALYSIS

The grant is the cost. Scrutiny is the revenue.

Every benefactor is granted **\$1.00 a week** — a real cost, not revenue. What comes back is our share of the pool that dollar joins, *priced by oversight*: **1/16** for a dormant mission up to **5/16** for one being arbitrated.

PURCHASED /WK	POOLED	OUR SHARE	NET
\$0 — grant only	\$1.00	\$0.31	−\$0.69
\$2	\$3.00	\$0.94	−\$0.06
\$5	\$6.00	\$1.88	+\$0.88

At the full 5/16 oversight share. Break-even purchased commitment: **\$2.20** a week at 5/16, \$4.33 at 3/16, \$15.00 at 1/16 — the quieter the mission, the more it has to be bought.

When does the pool cover the newsroom?

Six roles at **[\$450k]** a year — about \$8,650 a week — needs roughly **10,000 weekly-active benefactors** at the \$5 scenario. The \$2 scenario never gets there: this does not work on free grants alone.

Two levers, before headcount

A granted token costs nothing until it is committed, so the grant bill only arrives when the product is working. And our share rises with the scrutiny a mission needs — the missions that cost most to watch pay for the watching.

Challenge these: salary placeholder, no infrastructure line, unset tranche split.

Four quarters to a closed loop.

Q1 · Standing

Entity, charitable-status filing, banking. The mission page ships and the simulation runs against it. **Gate: the legal track is open, not just the code.**

Q2 · Counterparties

Organization registration, verification and outbound contact go live. First cohort signed; first mission *claimed* under the attestation. **Gate: a real organization on the record.**

Q3 · Money moves

First mission funded end to end: budget published, steps agreed, released in tranches. **Gate: the first check.**

Q4 · The loop closes

First independent audit published by a paid journalist. Retention measured across cycles; [N] weekly-active benefactors. **Gate: a story about what the money did.**

The legal track runs beside all four, not inside them. 501(c)(3) or fiscal sponsorship, the deductibility of each tranche, and the claim agreement itself. It has the longest lead time of anything on this slide and none of it is engineering.

THE ASK

[\$XXX,000] for [18] months of runway.

Use of funds

- **[40%] Newsroom.** A journalist and a mission auditor on payroll — the two roles that make coverage credible.
- **[25%] Engineering.** Finish the election surfaces, harden the wallet, ship mobile.
- **[20%] Organization relations.** Verifying organizations and signing the first cohort.
- **[15%] Legal & compliance.** Charitable status and the deductibility of tranches.

What it buys

- **[N] completed missions** with published audits, end to end.
- **[N] benefactors** voting weekly, with retention measured across cycles.
- **Proof of the loop:** a dollar in, a mission elected, money released in tranches, and a story about what it did.

[Name] · [email] · [site]

APPENDIX

Loaded, not shown.

The wallet states in full — unallocated → committed → minted → donated, and why mission-tied credit can't exist before its mission does.

The seven causes and the replacement rule — seven consecutive weeks for a challenger.

Risk register — vote brigading, an organization that takes the money and stalls, and the newsroom auditing a mission its own benefactors chose.

Sources for every figure on slides 2 and 3: [docs/RESEARCH.md](#) (NY AG *Pennies for Charity* 2024 · gift-in-kind valuations · joint-cost allocation · Kim/Charbonneau/Sowa 2024) and [docs/Donation_Recipient_Landscape.xlsx](#), Sources tab. **Cut, kept in reserve:** the enforcement-gap figures — 666 IRS examinations against 1.8M returns, and \$1.8B held by nonprofits that stopped filing.